

In a way, it also helps with reduction of noise-pollution, you know, by making sure your vehicle isn't making any funny loud sounds. It's a win-win-win!

LOOK FOR ENERGY STAR PRODUCTS

When buying products, especially around this time, i.e., the festive season, keep an eye out for Energy Star products. In India, this is the BEE Energy Star Rating, which is a label that tells you how power-efficient a product is. The rating is between 0 to 5 stars, with 5 stars being the most power-efficient. You ideally want products that are towards the higher rating side. Not only does this save you on your electricity bill, but they're also more eco-friendly.



LIGHTING MANAGEMENT

Incandescent light bulbs are incredibly inefficient. Almost 90 percent of the electricity used by them goes to waste. Something you can do to greatly reduce your house's carbon footprint is to switch out your incandescent and tube lights to light-emitting diodes or LEDs. While the initial costs are high, you ultimately end up not only reducing your carbon footprint, but also significantly reducing your electricity bill.

Another simple tactic to reduce your footprint, and save on your bill, is to simply delay turning your lights on. Make better use of natural lighting; keep those curtains open!

INSTALL A SOLAR PANEL IF YOU HAVE A ROOF

This one doesn't apply to everybody, of course, but if you live in an independent



house and have a roof, installing a solar panel is a great way to greatly reduce your carbon footprint. This way, you're actually actively being a part of those innovations that are making a difference on a global scale. Like with LEDs, the initial costs may be high, but not only are they much cheaper nowadays comparatively, in the long run, it'll also save you a lot on electricity bills.

GROW YOUR OWN BACKYARD GARDEN

In a similar vein as the last step, if you happen to have a yard or free space on your roof (you know, if you can't install solar panels), you could grow

paper right at the beginning of this article, but it's still a better alternative to plastic.

LINE-DRY YOUR CLOTHES

For all you lazy ones out there, we know this hurts, but it's for the good of the planet. A clothes dryer uses up a lot of electricity. Simply hanging your clothes out in the sun drastically drops your electricity usage, and in turn, your carbon footprint.

OPT FOR BETTER OFFICE PRODUCTS

Chances are converting everything in your workplace to a sustainable product will cost a bomb. However, you can focus on a single thing that has the biggest impact. Start switching out electrical appliances one by one for more eco-friendly ones with better BEE Energy Star Ratings, for example.

LONGER GADGET UPGRADE CYCLES

Use your gadgets, be it phones, tablets, laptops or PCs, till the very end of their life cycles. Buying a new phone every year or so is alluring, but mull over this – the energy that goes into making one smartphone is as much as recharging and operating the same smartphone for a year!



your very own garden. There are certain vegetables that take very well to backyard gardens and will flourish with minimal care on your part. This way, not only are you contributing to helping the planet, but you've also got yourself a free source of vegetables. Self-sustenance for the win! 